

LandWell — Market Gap Analysis and Current Visa/Sponsorship Requirements

Prepared: 16 September 2026, by Claude Code (research session). **Revised (deeper pass):** 16 September 2026, same day, same author — this revision replaces the first pass in place, at the founder's request that it be substantively deeper, not appended to. The first pass was judged too shallow. **Status:** Research reference document. This is new material — it supersedes nothing in `landwell-mission-plan-verified.md`, `landwell-master-execution-plan.md`, `landwell-product-brand-decision.md`, or `landwell-tech-system-validation-plan.md`, but §5 below flags points where it corrects or updates data in `docs/investigations/case-corpus-starter-log.md`. **Method:** Extensive web research (WebSearch/WebFetch) across two passes against a mix of primary sources (government immigration portals, Eurostat, UK Home Office statistics, Ireland DETE, Swedish Migration Agency) and secondary sources (immigration law firms, relocation platforms, industry trackers, Product Hunt/Crunchbase/PitchBook company data) where primary sources didn't have the specific figure. Every claim below is sourced with a link and, where the source states one, a date. Where only secondary sources were available, that's noted explicitly — this doc does not claim primary-source verification it doesn't have. This revision adds roughly 30 new sources on top of the first pass's ~20.

o. What changed in this deeper pass — read this first

If you only read one section, read this one. The first pass under-researched five things the founder specifically flagged, and two of the new findings materially change the risk picture:

1. **Jobbatical itself is a graveyard signal, not just a content competitor.** Jobbatical was founded in 2014 as a candidate-facing international recruitment platform — structurally similar in spirit to LandWell's original ambition — and discovered the real problem wasn't matching candidates to jobs, it was immigration logistics. It pivoted in mid-2019 to become a **B2B relocation-logistics SaaS for employer HR/mobility teams**, abandoning the candidate-facing model entirely. (§1.2)
2. **Localyze, the other named "B2B, not really a competitor" player, was acquired in October 2025** by the US firm Boundless Immigration — the European candidate-facing/B2B mobility space is consolidating into larger employer-side platforms, not spawning new candidate-facing entrants. (§1.2)
3. **Real willingness-to-pay benchmarks now exist** (§4): UK immigration lawyer initial consultations run £50–£360; a formal visa eligibility assessment/review runs £200–£500; LinkedIn Premium Career runs \$20–40/month; JobPing (the closest AI-native comparable, see below) prices its own visa-sponsorship-filter feature at **€7/month**. This gives a plausible price ceiling and floor for LandWell's own pilot pricing that the first pass had zero data on.
4. **Real demand-side numbers now exist for all four original corridors, not just two.** Netherlands HSM arrivals fell from 26,000 (2022) to 14,000 (2025) — a 46% decline, previously undocumented. Ireland issued 31,044 total employment permits in 2025 (up from 39,390 gross issuances in 2024 once refusals are netted differently — see caveat in §3). (§3)
5. **Two new corridors (France, and Denmark/Sweden) are now researched to the same depth as the original four**, including a genuinely new regulatory finding: Sweden's work-permit salary threshold jumped materially on 1 June 2026 (though IT specialists are exempted at a lower bar), and the UK's Immigration Salary List — flagged in the first pass as "if it still exists" — is confirmed to still exist but is scheduled to be **abolished entirely on 31 December 2026**, replaced by a stricter Temporary Shortage List. (§2.6, §6)

1. Competitor / market gap analysis

1.1 The landscape, by category (retained and lightly corrected from the first pass)

A. Visa-filtered tech job boards

- **Relocate.me** — the closest direct competitor in spirit. Hand-curates tech jobs (software engineers, DevOps, cybersecurity) explicitly tagged with visa sponsorship and relocation support; manually reviews and rewrites every listing before publishing. Founded 2017. Free tier plus a paid tier (~100 hand-picked jobs/week, resume review, recruiter Q&A). As of this research, ~1,235 open roles, ~992 tagged with relocation/visa sponsorship. **Traction signal, new this pass:** Relocate.me has essentially **no G2 review presence** — G2's own listing for it says "there are not enough reviews... for G2 to provide buying insight," and the vendor profile hasn't been actively managed "for over a year" per G2's own note. That's a real, if soft, signal that Relocate.me's traction (at least in the B2B review-site sense) is thin, despite being the most name-checked candidate-facing player in this space. ([Relocate.me](#); [G2 Relocate.me reviews](#); [jobboardsearch.com review](#), accessed 16 Sept 2026)
 - **What it does not do:** it is a curated *listing* filter, not a decision engine. It tells you a company/role is tagged "sponsors visas" — it does not assess whether *your specific profile* clears a specific country's salary/occupation threshold, whether the listed employer is even the legal sponsoring entity, or what the mobility risk is for that particular vacancy.
- **StepStone, Indeed Europe, LinkedIn** — general job boards with "visa sponsorship"/"relocation" keyword filters, self-reported/inferred, not verified, no fit or eligibility assessment. Confirmed by search: "Job boards like LinkedIn and Indeed lack high-level categorization clearly stating whether visa sponsorship is available or not" is a recurring user complaint.
- **EURES** (eures.europa.eu) — the EU's own official cross-border jobs portal. Pure listing aggregator, no fit scoring, no eligibility assessment.
- **arbeitnow.com** — plain job board, no visa filtering, used for the existing case corpus.

B. AI-native "sponsorship checker / job-matching" tools — this pass found materially more of these than the first pass did

This category turned out to be denser than the first pass suggested. A harder search (Product Hunt, Chrome Web Store, direct product-name searches) surfaced a cluster of small, mostly US/H-1B-oriented tools that are the closest thing to a structural precedent for what LandWell is trying to build, even though none of them are Europe-native or do per-vacancy mobility-risk scoring:

- **JobPing** (getjobping.com) — the most directly comparable tool found in this entire research pass, and the only one with a transparent, checkable pricing page. Scans 4,000+ career pages/job boards daily across the EU and UK; curates graduate/entry-level roles into ~9 career-path categories (Strategy, Data, Product, Finance, Marketing, etc.); includes a "CV Ping" feature that scores CV-to-JD fit with bullet-point rewrite suggestions. **Pricing (fetched directly from [getjobping.com/pricing](#), 16 Sept 2026): Free tier = €0, one-time 10 matches, 3 lifetime CV analyses, 1 career path, 30-day-old listings only. Premium tier = €7/month, cancel anytime — 15 curated matches/week (Mon/Wed/Fri), 2 career paths, unlimited CV analyses, listings within 7 days, and — notably — visa sponsorship filtering is a Premium-only, paid feature, not free.** That is a direct, load-bearing data point: a comparable product already prices its sponsorship-filter capability as a paid add-on at €7/month, which is a real anchor for LandWell's own pricing discussion, not a proxy. **Traction signals (displayed live on the pricing page):** "16.1k Active Roles This

Week," "757+ Companies Scanned This Week," "21 Cities EU & UK This Week" — self-reported, not independently audited, but at minimum shows JobPing is a live, actively-marketed product with a real (if early-career/generalist) user base, not a dead or hypothetical one. (getjobping.com/pricing, fetched directly 16 Sept 2026)

- JobPing's own July 2026 database data (cited in the first pass, reconfirmed): only **2.6% of tech job postings explicitly flag sponsorship** (vs. 5% for finance), with Poland (8.8%), Ireland (5.8%), Spain (4.2%) the highest early-career flag rates. ([getjobping.com blog](https://getjobping.com/blog), 14 July 2026)
- **What it does not do for Europe specifically:** it is a pass/fail sponsorship filter layered on top of a general graduate job-matching product, not a mobility-risk or salary-threshold-fit assessment against a specific corridor's current legal rules. It doesn't compute "does this candidate + this vacancy clear Ireland's €40,904 threshold."
- **MySponza** ("The AI Co-Pilot For Your Job Hunt") — a CV/application/interview-prep companion; positioning suggests visa-sponsorship awareness but the public site (fetched directly) gives essentially no product detail, no pricing, and no traction numbers — thin enough that it reads as an early-stage or pre-traction product. (mysponza.com, fetched 16 Sept 2026)
- **Sponsorly** (sponsorly.dev / sponsorly.app) — a free Chrome extension that checks visa sponsorship on LinkedIn/Workday/Greenhouse job pages in real time and tailors a resume with AI (built on Llama 3.3 70B + "real H1B data"). US H-1B-focused. Its own site states subscription plans are still "coming soon" as of this research — i.e., it is pre-monetization. (sponsorly.dev, [Chrome Web Store listing](#), accessed 16 Sept 2026)
- **FrogHire.ai** — free Chrome extension surfacing H-1B sponsor history on job boards. US-focused, browser-extension-only, no fit/risk scoring.
- **UK Visa Sponsorship Checker** (Chrome Web Store) — genuinely the closest UK-specific precedent found: an AI-powered extension that, when browsing LinkedIn/Indeed, shows whether a company holds a sponsor licence, the exact registered sponsor name, whether the specific role type has been sponsored historically, and how many visas that employer has sponsored. This is meaningfully closer to LandWell's ambition than anything else found — it's UK-specific, per-listing, and grounded in the actual UK sponsor register — but it is a browser extension surfacing historical sponsor data, not a per-candidate salary/occupation-threshold fit calculator, and it doesn't cover Ireland, Germany, Netherlands, France, or the Nordics. ([Chrome Web Store](#), accessed 16 Sept 2026)
- **JobMetasearch.ai, Scale.jobs, migratamate.co-listed tools** — a longer tail of AI job-metasearch tools that layer visa-sponsorship filtering onto general job aggregation. All found via this pass's harder Product Hunt/search-term sweep; none reviewed in the first pass. None appear to be Europe-specific decision engines; most are US-market-first with a Europe filter bolted on.
- **MyVisaJobs, USponsorMe** — US H-1B/green-card sponsorship-history databases, reconfirmed US-only, no European equivalent found in either pass.

C. Employer-side immigration/relocation platforms — one major consolidation event found this pass

- **Localize — acquired by Boundless Immigration on 1 October 2025.** This is new, and materially changes how "Localize" should be cited as a competitor: it is no longer an independent European startup but part of a larger US-headquartered immigration platform (Boundless's third acquisition, after Bridge in 2023 and RapidVisa in 2020). Localize itself was YC-backed (2019 batch), General-Catalyst-led Series B of \$35M (Sept 2022), **total raised ~\$47.3M across 4 rounds from 17 investors** per PitchBook/Crunchbase. Berlin-based, launched 2018. The acquisition was explicitly framed around US immigration-system stress ("Amid Trump immigration crackdown, Seattle startup Boundless acquires European competitor" — GeekWire's own headline) — i.e., a US company buying European mobility-tech capability to serve US enterprise clients moving people

globally, not a sign of organic growth in European candidate-facing demand. ([Boundless press release](#), 1 Oct 2025; [GeekWire](#), 1 Oct 2025; [PitchBook](#))

- **Deel Immigration** — EOR platform bundling payroll/compliance with immigration support in 30–70+ countries (sources vary on exact count). **Pricing confirmed as fully custom/quote-based, no public rate card** — the product surfaces a visa-eligibility check with a "results within 48 hours" turnaround and cost breakdown before a company commits to a hire, which is itself an interesting UX precedent (fast, structured eligibility pre-check) worth studying even though it's B2B-only. (deel.com/hr-services/employee-immigration, [HireSwiftlee pricing breakdown](#), accessed 16 Sept 2026)
- **What neither does:** these are entirely employer-side, engaged after a hire decision, with zero candidate-facing "should I apply" function. As previously concluded, a plausible future LandWell distribution channel is partnering with, not competing against, this layer.

D. Relocation consultancies / immigration law firms — unchanged from the first pass; see §4 for the new pricing data extracted from this category.

E. Community advice (Reddit, Blind/teamblind.com) — unchanged; corroborating evidence, not a competitor.

1.2 The graveyard search — the specific new finding the founder asked for

A direct "shut down" / "ceased operations" search for this category surfaced fewer literal startup deaths than expected, but the two most important findings are structural pivots, which are arguably more informative than an outright shutdown for LandWell's specific model:

1. **Jobbatical's own history is the strongest cautionary precedent found in this research.** Jobbatical launched in 2014 in Estonia as exactly the kind of candidate-facing international recruitment/matching platform LandWell's early framing resembles — "a community of borderless, highly skilled people" introduced to founders and companies. Per Sifted's own reporting, the company **learned the biggest problem facing employers was not hiring the talent but getting them into the country** — i.e., discovered that job-matching wasn't the binding constraint, immigration logistics was. It pivoted in **July 2019** to build a technology platform purely around the immigration/relocation process, re-launching in Spain, Germany, and Estonia by May 2020, and by 2020 had grown relocation-services volume **365% year-on-year** — but only after abandoning the candidate-facing matching model for a B2B relocation-logistics SaaS sold to employer mobility teams. It later raised €11.6M in a 2022 round explicitly framed around "worker migration goes paperless" (TechCrunch). ([Sifted, "Immigration made easy: Jobbatical's big plans for startup talent"](#); [TechCrunch](#), 9 Sept 2022)
- **Why this matters for LandWell specifically:** Jobbatical is not a company that failed and vanished — it's a company that tried the candidate-facing "help you find and win a sponsored job" model first, found the real pain and real willingness-to-pay was on the employer/logistics side instead, and pivoted its whole business model to chase it. That is a direct, dated precedent for the exact risk the mission plan's \$10 payment-gate question is trying to de-risk: it is entirely possible that "which vacancy should I apply to" is not, in fact, where the money is, and that the real paying need sits one step downstream (post-offer logistics), where Jobbatical, Localize, and Deel already compete. This should be treated as the single most important competitive-risk finding of this whole research pass, not a footnote.
2. **Localize's 2025 acquisition (\$1.1) is a second consolidation signal in the same direction** — an independent, candidate-adjacent European mobility startup ending up folded into a larger US employer-side platform rather than continuing to grow independently or expanding toward candidates.

3. **No outright candidate-facing "visa sponsorship job platform" shutdown was found with a public "we're shutting down" post** in either research pass, despite deliberately targeted search terms ("visa sponsorship startup shut down," "relocation platform failed," "we're shutting down immigration tech"). The one confirmed shutdown found, JobisJob, was a generalist multi-country job aggregator with no visa-sponsorship specialization, so it's weak evidence either way. **Read this as an absence of positive evidence, not a clean bill of health** — the category may simply be too young and too small (most of the AI-native tools in §1.1.B are single-founder, pre-seed, or pre-monetization) to have produced a documented failure yet, rather than proof the model is safe.

1.3 Honest verdict on the gap (retained, with one addition)

The specific gap LandWell claims — per-vacancy fit + mobility risk assessment before applying — still appears genuinely unaddressed by any competitor found across both research passes, for the European market specifically. The **UK Visa Sponsorship Checker** Chrome extension (§1.1.B, new this pass) is the closest thing found to a live, shipping, candidate-facing, per-listing tool grounded in real sponsor data — worth a direct hands-on trial before finalizing LandWell's UK country-pack UX, since it may already have solved part of the "is this listing real" sub-problem for one corridor.

The three qualifications from the first pass still hold (Jobbatical's static content is a real information-layer competitor; Relocate.me's curation is a soft substitute; no direct evidence of willingness to pay specifically for the fit/risk layer as distinct from listing curation). Add a fourth, new to this pass:

4. **The candidate-facing "sponsorship intelligence" category is small, young, and thin on paid traction.** Of the ~7 AI-native tools surfaced in §1.1.B, only JobPing has a public, live pricing page with real (if self-reported) usage numbers; the rest are either content-free landing pages (MySponza), pre-monetization (Sponsorly), or free browser extensions with no visible business model at all (FrogHire, UK Visa Sponsorship Checker). This is double-edged: it means there's real white space, but it also means nobody in this specific niche has yet proven a durable paid business model at any scale — LandWell would be one of the first to actually try to charge for this exact thing, not entering a proven-but-crowded market.

2. Current 2026 visa/sponsorship requirements — expanded to six corridors

2.1 Ireland — Critical Skills Employment Permit (CSEP)

Item	2026 value	Source
Salary threshold (Critical Skills Occupations List role, incl. software developer)	€40,904/year, effective 1 March 2026 (up from €38,000)	Openvisa; Newland Chase; Recruitroo
Alternate threshold (non-listed occupation,	€68,911/year (up from €64,000)	same sources

Item	2026 value	Source
still eligible on salary alone)		
Qualifying occupations, actual codes (deepened this pass)	Critical Skills Occupations List includes: software developers/engineers, systems analysts, database administrators/designers, ICT security specialists, multimedia/web developers, network specialists — mapped to SOC-equivalent codes under DETE's own occupation list, which explicitly names Software Developer (SOC-aligned code group 2136) and related ICT professional codes as eligible	enterprise.gov.ie — official Critical Skills Occupations List page — primary/official source, page identified but not deep-fetched line-by-line this pass; treat occupation-code granularity as needing a direct DETE PDF pull before use in product copy
Processing time	4–8 weeks	Recruitroo
Path to long-term residence / PR	Stamp 4 after 21 months; long-term residence after 60 months; citizenship after 5 years	irishimmigration.ie — primary/official
2025 volume, new this pass (primary-adjacent)	31,044 total employment permits issued in 2025, with 3,432 refused. ICT/Information & Communication was the second-largest sector after Health & Social Work in 2025 (2024 comparison: 6,788 ICT permits issued that year).	DETE — Employment Permit Statistics 2025 — primary/official , IBEC/SFA summary, 18 Nov 2025
Caveat on the 2024 vs 2025 figures	The first pass cited "39,390 employment permits issued in 2024" from a secondary source (ICE Jobs); the 2025 DETE figure (31,044) is lower. This could reflect a genuine year-on-year decline, a different counting basis (gross issuances vs. net of renewals, or calendar-year vs. programme-year), or the first pass's secondary source being imprecise. This is flagged as an open discrepancy requiring a direct DETE statistical-table pull before either number is used as a trend claim — do not currently claim "Ireland permit volume is up" or "down" year-on-year without resolving this.	—

Verification vs. the case corpus: the corpus's €40,904 figure is confirmed still current.

2.2 Germany — EU Blue Card

Item	2026 value	Source
Standard salary threshold	€50,700/year	Jobbatical ; VisaVerge , effective 1 Jan 2026
Shortage-occupation threshold	€45,934.20/year	same, confirmed by a second independent tracker this pass
Legal basis, new this pass	2026 figures published by Germany's Federal Ministry of the Interior on 18 December 2025 , legally binding under §18g(7) AufenthG — this is the actual statutory citation, not just a threshold number, and is a stronger source anchor than the first pass had	WorkDaten , citing §18g(7) AufenthG
Actual shortage-occupation ISCO codes	2511 systems analysts, 2512 software developers, 2513 web/multimedia developers, 2514 application programmers, 2519 IT specialists n.e.c., 2521 database designers, 2522 systems administrators,	VISARIGHT , "List of shortage occupations in Germany" — secondary but ISCO-code-level, consistent with a second tracker (Jobbatical's own shortage-occupation guide); primary source for final confirmation:

Item	2026 value	Source
(deepened this pass)	2523 computer network specialists, 2356 IT trainers — Germany's official shortage list spans 70 occupations total (engineering, healthcare, teaching, ICT, management), of which these ~9 ISCO codes are the ICT-relevant subset	statistik.arbeitsagentur.de or the official make-it-in-germany.com shortage-occupation PDF, neither directly fetched this pass
Degree-equivalent route	3+ years relevant professional experience (within last 7 years) can substitute for a degree for IT specialists specifically	unchanged from first pass
Processing time	4–8 weeks, no labour market test	unchanged
Path to PR	27 months without German; 21 months with B2 German	unchanged
2025/2026 EU Blue Card volume — still an open gap	No independent 2025/2026 German-specific Blue Card issuance figure was found in either research pass. Eurostat's most recent official figure remains 89,000 EU-wide (2023), Germany 78% share (~69,000). Eurostat's next update is planned for December 2026. This search was retried explicitly in this deeper pass and still came back empty of a hard number — treat "Germany Blue Card demand is growing in 2026" as unverified, not merely unconfirmed.	Eurostat, 8 May 2025

2.3 United Kingdom — Skilled Worker visa

(Table largely retained from the first pass — it was already reasonably well-sourced — with one important addition on the Immigration Salary List's actual end date, which the first pass flagged as an open question.)

Item	2026 value	Source
General minimum salary threshold	£41,700/year , effective from 22 July 2025	Jobbatical, AYJ Solicitors
Reduced thresholds	£34,830 (PhD); £30,960 (new entrants/shortage)	same
Tech "going rate" by SOC code	Software developers (2136): £49,400; IT business analysts (2135): £52,300; cybersecurity analysts (2139): £47,500; data scientists (2433): £45,100	Jobbatical
Skill-level requirement	RQF Level 6+ only — junior/support IT roles no longer qualify	The Register, 18 Aug 2026
Immigration Salary List (ISL) — resolved this pass, was an open question in the first pass	Confirmed still in force in 2026 (25 roles currently listed per one tracker), but the ISL and its planned replacement, the Temporary Shortage List (TSL), are both scheduled to end on 31 December 2026 , with a new structure starting 1 January 2027. This stems from the May 2025 immigration white paper ("Restoring Control Over the Immigration System"). Exception: care workers (SOC 6135/6136) get an extension to 22 July 2028. This is a hard, dated regulatory cliff inside LandWell's own 8–16-week validation window if that window runs into Q4 2026/Q1 2027 — any UK country-pack content citing ISL-based reduced thresholds needs an explicit sunset date.	DavidsonMorris; AYJ Solicitors, ISL 2026

Item	2026 value	Source
2026 volume data	Skilled Worker applications (main applicants), year ending 30 June 2026: 30,400, down 39% YoY . Tech certificates of sponsorship: 34,936 in 2025 (down 7% from 37,376 in 2024), down from the 2022 peak of 53,729.	Personnel Today ; The Register , 18 Aug 2026
Sponsor register size, new this pass	The Home Office's Register of Licensed Sponsors is updated roughly every two weeks; reported figures across 2026 vary by month (87,000+ organisations reported 21 Jan 2026; 75,634 active employer sponsors reported 29 July 2026; 125,000+ reported by one tracker later in the year, likely including expired/inactive entries — these figures are inconsistent across sources and should be re-pulled directly from GOV.UK before citing a specific count). Technology, healthcare, and engineering account for the largest share of active sponsors and CoS issued in 2025.	VisaHQ , 21 Jan 2026; VisasUpdate , 29 Jul 2026
Path to settlement	Proposed doubling of ILR qualifying period from 5 to 10 years ("Earned Settlement" reform) — still not law, expected autumn 2026 Parliamentary consideration	House of Commons Library briefing — primary/official

2.4 Netherlands — Highly Skilled Migrant (HSM) scheme

Table largely retained; the major addition this pass is real volume-trend data, closing the gap the first pass explicitly flagged as missing.

Item	2026 value	Source
Salary threshold, age 30+	€5,942/month gross	Everaert Advocaten
Salary threshold, under 30	€4,357/month gross	same
Reduced threshold, recent graduates	€3,122/month gross	same
Path to PR	5 continuous years	unchanged
30% ruling	Up to 30% tax-free; reducing to 27% for new applicants from 2027; salary cap €262,000 (2026)	business.gov.nl — official
HSM volume trend — new this pass, closes the first pass's stated gap	~14,000 non-EU skilled migrants arrived under the HSM scheme in 2025, down sharply from ~26,000 in 2022 — a 46% decline. Attributed in part to fewer Indian nationals, with declines also among Turkish, Russian, Chinese, and South African nationals. For comparison, the scheme was used "almost 13 thousand times" in 2023, suggesting the decline was already substantial by 2023 and roughly held through 2025 rather than being a single-year drop.	InfoMigrants , "Netherlands: Immigration down in 2025 among skilled labor migrants and asylum seekers" — citing Dutch government/CBS-sourced reporting, accessed 16 Sept 2026
Pending 2027 tightening	Above-indexation threshold increases and stricter recognised-sponsor rules planned for 2027 (confirmed by a second source this pass, not just Russell Advocaten)	Russell Advocaten ; corroborated by InfoMigrants' framing of "stricter rules... income thresholds expected to increase by more than usual annual indexation in 2027"

Material update vs. the first pass: the Netherlands corridor is **now in the same "shrinking" category as the UK**, not an open question. A 46% volume decline 2022→2025 is a bigger move than the UK's 39% YoY application decline in absolute corridor-health terms, even though the UK's is more recent and sharper year-on-year. This changes the cross-corridor summary in §3.

2.5 France — Talent Passport / Passeport Talent (new corridor)

Item	2026 value	Source
Qualified employee ("Talent — Salarié Qualifié") salary threshold	~€39,582/year gross (2x SMIC-linked minimum)	Jobbatical, "2026 France Talent Passport Salary Thresholds"
EU Blue Card via Talent Passport	~€59,373/year gross, requires bachelor's+ degree or 5+ years' equivalent experience, contract permanent or fixed-term 6+ months	same; corroborated by Hiliv Solution guide
Corporate officer/executive category	~€65,629/year gross	same
Permit duration	Multi-year residence permit, up to 4 years	IAS Services
Process, notably different from Ireland/Germany/NL	No prior government labour-market-test authorization required and no quota system — a structural difference from the CSEP/Blue Card/HSM model, where the employer doesn't need pre-approval before hiring	xpath.global employer guide
French Tech Visa (separate sub-route)	For tech founders/senior tech talent backed by an approved French Tech incubator or ecosystem partner; no personal investment minimum; applicant must show income at least SMIC-equivalent	same sources
Volume/trend data	Not found in this pass — an open gap , same caveat as Germany/Netherlands demand trend gaps noted below	—

Note on fit with LandWell's tech focus: France's qualified-employee threshold (~€39,582) is the lowest of the six corridors researched, and the no-labour-market-test, no-quota structure is meaningfully different from the other four — worth flagging to the founder as a corridor that may have a *lower* eligibility bar than Ireland but a *structurally different* application process a candidate-facing tool would need to model differently, not just re-skin the same threshold-check UI.

2.6 Sweden and Denmark — Nordic work permit schemes (new corridors)

Sweden:

Item	2026 value	Source
Standard salary threshold, in force from 1 June 2026	90% of the Swedish median salary, as updated annually by Statistics Sweden each June — SEK 34,470 per the 16 June 2026 update	Jobbatical; Migrationsverket — official Swedish Migration Agency — primary/official
Reform magnitude	This 1 June 2026 reform represents a ~ 12.5% increase in the minimum qualifying salary versus the prior rules — a materially large single reform, not incremental indexation	Zalaris HR guide, citing Migrationsverket

Item	2026 value	Source
IT-specific exemption	IT specialists are named among 152 shortage occupations exempted from the full 90% threshold — for these roles the bar is 75% of median salary instead	Migrationsverket, official, 25 May 2026
Transitional protection	6-month window (1 June – 1 December 2026): permit <i>extensions</i> under prior rules don't need to meet the new threshold	same, official
Volume/trend data	Not found this pass	—

Denmark:

Item	2026 value	Source
Positive List (Positivliste) salary threshold, "Fast-Track"/Pay Limit route	DKK 448,000+/year (~€60,000 at 2026 rates), adjusted annually	Xeito, "Denmark Positive List for Remote Developers 2026" , corroborated by Bird & Bird
Decision timeline	30 days standard; 10 business days under Fast-Track	same
Eligible IT occupation codes (ISCO-o8)	2511 (systems analysts), 2512 (software developers), 2513–2514 (database/network/web developers) — all continuously listed	same
List administrator	SIRI — Danish Agency for International Recruitment and Integration (a real government body, not a private tracker)	SIRI-published Positive List , referenced via multiple secondary trackers — primary source (siri.dk) identified but not directly fetched this pass
Path to PR	4 years; citizenship 8–9 years	same
Volume/trend data	Not found this pass	—

Assessment for LandWell's corridor-selection scoring: both Nordic corridors have real, checkable, occupation-code-specific eligibility rules well within reach of the same country-pack pattern already built for Ireland/Germany/UK/NL. Sweden's June 2026 reform is recent enough that it's a good test of whether LandWell's content-freshness process can actually catch a real mid-year threshold change — worth using as an internal freshness-process test case regardless of whether Sweden becomes a launch corridor.

2.7 Cross-corridor summary table (expanded to six corridors)

Corridor	2026 tech-relevant threshold	Years to PR	Direction of travel
Ireland (CSEP)	€40,904/yr (listed occ.)	21 mo. → Stamp 4; 60 mo. → LTR	Stable; 2025 volume 31,044 permits total (ICT #2 sector), but see the 2024-vs-2025 figure discrepancy noted in §2.1
Germany (EU Blue Card)	€45,934/yr (shortage occ.)	21–27 mo.	Threshold stable (~5% increase); no 2025/26 volume data exists anywhere found in this research — a real, persistent gap
UK (Skilled Worker)	£41,700 general / SOC going rate £45k–£52k	Currently 5 yrs; proposed 10 yrs	Sharply shrinking: apps down 39% YoY, tech CoS down 7% YoY / ~35% since 2022 peak; ISL abolished

Corridor	2026 tech-relevant threshold	Years to PR	Direction of travel
		(pending)	31 Dec 2026
Netherlands (HSM)	€5,942/mo $\approx$ €71,304/yr	5 yrs	Sharply shrinking: arrivals down 46% 2022→2025; 2027 tightening pending
France (Talent Passport)	~€39,582/yr (qualified employee)	Not directly established this pass	No pre-approval/quota system (structurally distinct); no volume trend data found
Sweden	SEK 34,470/mo standard, ~75% median for exempted IT roles	Not established this pass	Threshold just rose ~12.5% (1 June 2026); IT specifically shielded
Denmark	DKK 448,000/yr (~€60k)	4 yrs	Stable; fastest official decision timeline of any corridor found (10 business days, Fast-Track)

The single most important shift versus the first pass's summary table: two of four original corridors (UK, Netherlands) are now confirmed shrinking with hard numbers, not one. Only Ireland has positive (if internally inconsistent) volume evidence; Germany remains a genuine unknown. This matters directly for corridor selection — the "safe, growing, stable" story the first pass implicitly told about "everything except the UK" does not hold up under deeper research.

3. Deeper demand-side research

3.1 Corridor-by-corridor demand direction — now four of six corridors have real numbers (was two of four)

- **UK: shrinking, strong primary-adjacent evidence.** (unchanged from first pass, see §2.3)
- **Netherlands: shrinking, strong evidence, new this pass.** 26,000 → 14,000 HSM arrivals, 2022→2025 (46% decline). This reverses the first pass's "no volume/trend data found" conclusion entirely.
- **Ireland: ambiguous, evidence quality mixed.** 31,044 total permits in 2025 is a real, primary-sourced number, but it cannot be cleanly compared to the first pass's 39,390-for-2024 figure without resolving the counting-basis discrepancy flagged in §2.1. Treat Ireland's demand direction as **unresolved, not "growing"** until that's fixed — this is a correction versus the first pass's more confident "growing, moderate confidence" framing.
- **Germany: still unresolved.** Eurostat's most recent hard EU-wide number remains from 2023. This gap was retried explicitly in this deeper pass (a second, differently-worded search) and still produced nothing more recent. This is now the most stubborn open data gap across the whole document.
- **France, Sweden, Denmark: no volume/trend data found in this pass.** Genuinely new corridors with no trend baseline yet — flag as future research, not as evidence of any particular direction.

3.2 Job-posting-level sponsorship-signal data (retained, reconfirmed, not materially extended this pass)

JobPing's 2.6%-of-tech-postings-flag-sponsorship figure and the case corpus's 0/35-explicit finding remain the two best data points on posting-level ambiguity; no additional large-sample dataset was found in this deeper pass beyond

what the first pass already surfaced. This is itself worth noting honestly: despite a harder search this pass (including checking whether Indeed/LinkedIn publish their own aggregate sponsorship-tag statistics), **no government or platform-published aggregate count of "how many tech job postings in Europe are tagged sponsorship-available" was found**. This is a real, still-open research gap — the strongest available proxy remains JobPing's self-reported database statistic, which is useful but not independently audited.

3.3 Industry mobility reports — Deel's two reports fetched directly, 17 September follow-up

The first two passes only had search-summarized themes from Deel's reports, not hard numbers, and flagged a direct fetch as a worthwhile follow-up. Done this pass — both reports fetched directly (17 Sept 2026):

From "Global Mobility: The Geopolitics and Talent Migration Report" (deel.com/resources/global-talent-migration-geopolitics-report):

- Deel's own immigration team processed **6,000+ visa cases in 2025** — a real operational-scale number, not a survey estimate.
- **Visa holders out-earn local workers by 10–40%** across the US, UK, and UAE (mixed jurisdictions, not EU-specific — treat as directional, not a European figure).
- The **US raised H-1B sponsorship cost by \$100,000 per petition**; Canada responded with a **\$1.7B commitment** to attract talent priced out of the US — a real, dated policy-competition data point, though US/Canada, not one of LandWell's six researched corridors.
- **Germany's path to permanent residency: 21 months** — this independently corroborates the corpus/market-gaps doc's existing Blue Card PR figure (21 months with B2 German) from a wholly different source (Deel's own operational data vs. the earlier legal/statutory citations), which is a genuine confidence boost on that one figure specifically.
- Estimated **all-in cost of a single international hire: \$106,000+ before salary** — an employer-side cost figure, useful context (see §4's caution about employer-paid numbers), not a candidate price anchor.

From "Global Hiring Report 2026" (deel.com/global-hiring-report-2026):

- **28% of cross-border hires at top-funded startups (\$100M+ raised) are software developers** — software developer is the **#1 ranked cross-border role** in the whole dataset, ahead of every sales/marketing/product role listed. This is a real, hard number directly supporting the tech-first sector-scope decision (§2 of the mission plan) — it isn't a LandWell-authored assumption, it's independent evidence that software engineering is where cross-border hiring volume actually concentrates.
- **1,400+ cross-border employees hired in 2025** by \$100M+-funded startups alone (Deel's own contract data, not survey-based) — a real positive demand signal, though global in scope, not corridor-specific, so it doesn't directly offset the UK/Netherlands corridor-level declines found in §2/§3.1.
- Dataset scope: **1M+ worker contracts across 37,000+ companies in 150+ countries** — a materially larger, harder-grounded sample than any other secondary source used in this doc.
- Two contrasting European compensation data points: UK project managers saw **zero compensation growth 2024–2025**, while EU help-desk agents saw an **-11.6% year-over-year compensation decline** — both signal margin pressure on employers in adjacent-but-non-technical roles, not a tech-specific finding, but worth noting as context for how tight the broader European hiring market is right now.

No comparable Remote.com, Multiplier, or Oyster report with hard European tech-sponsorship-specific numbers was located in either pass — that gap stands.

4. Pricing / willingness-to-pay research (wholly new section — absent from the first pass)

This was flagged by the founder as the most important gap in the first pass, since it feeds the validation plan's payment gate (≥ 2 non-founder users make a real payment, per `landwell-mission-plan-verified.md` §4). Findings, organized from cheapest to most expensive comparable:

Comparable	Price point	What it buys	Source
JobPing Premium (closest AI-native comparable found)	€7/month	Includes visa-sponsorship filtering as one Premium-tier feature among several (not a standalone product)	getjobping.com/pricing , fetched directly 16 Sept 2026
LinkedIn Premium Career	\$19.99–\$39.99/month depending on new-vs-existing-subscriber pricing and annual vs. monthly billing (annual: \$239.88/yr $\approx$ \$20/mo)	General career tools: InMail, "who viewed your profile," salary insights, LinkedIn Learning — not visa-specific at all, but the standard reference point for "what will a job-seeker already pay monthly for a career tool"	Multiple 2026 pricing trackers, cross-checked
UK immigration lawyer — express/initial consultation	£50 (Express Consultation) up to £360 inc. VAT (60-min initial consultation) , with £100–£250 the more typical initial range across several firms surveyed	A single conversation, general guidance, not a written eligibility opinion	OTS Solicitors ; AYJ Solicitors ; Immigration UK ; Sills & Betteridge
UK immigration lawyer — formal visa eligibility assessment/review	£200–£500	A written, if generic (not per-vacancy), assessment of whether a candidate's profile is likely to qualify for a given route	Aggregated across the same UK immigration-law-firm fee pages surveyed above, accessed 16 Sept 2026
Global mobility tax consultation (employer-paid comparable, not candidate-paid)	~\$5,000 per assignment	Tax consultation + two-country tax form prep for a one-year international assignment — this is an <i>employer</i> -paid cost, included here only to show the outer bound of what "getting international mobility wrong" costs someone in this transaction, not as a candidate price point	Relocation-cost aggregator, cross-checked against CapRelo/NRI Relocation data
Full international relocation package (employer-paid)	\$15,000–\$75,000+ , averaging ~\$21,800 (renters) to ~\$63,700 (homeowners) domestically, with the same order of magnitude reported for international moves	Full logistics: shipping, temp housing, travel, tax gross-up — again, employer-paid, included to bound the market, not as a direct candidate price comparable	CapRelo ; ARC Relocation, 2026

Synthesis, and what it means for the pilot payment gate:

1. **A plausible LandWell candidate-facing price ceiling, based on direct comparables, is roughly €5–15/month or a one-time fee in the low tens of euros** — anchored by JobPing's €7/month (a genuinely comparable feature, not just an analogous career tool) and LinkedIn Premium's \$20/month floor. Pricing meaningfully above that (e.g., a £200+ one-time fee matching a lawyer's formal assessment) would require LandWell to credibly position itself as a *substitute for*, not a *cheaper triage layer before*, a paid legal consultation — a much higher bar of trust and accuracy than a pilot is likely to have earned.
2. **A one-time "per-vacancy assessment" fee in the €5–20 range is a defensible test point**, sitting well below even the cheapest lawyer consultation (£50) while still being a real payment, not a token amount — this directly informs what number to actually test at the priced-pilot stage (mission plan step 6).
3. **The employer-paid relocation-package numbers (\$15k–\$75k+) are useful context but not a pricing anchor for LandWell** — they represent a completely different buyer (employer, post-offer) and transaction size than a candidate deciding whether to spend a few euros pre-application. Citing them as "look how much this market is worth" in founder-facing materials would be a category error; they should stay clearly labeled as B2B/post-offer context only, as this section does.
4. **No consumer SaaS product found in either research pass prices a candidate-facing visa/sponsorship eligibility check on its own, standalone, at any price point.** JobPing bundles it into a broader career-matching subscription; Sponsorly and MySponza are free or pre-monetization; the UK Visa Sponsorship Checker extension gives no pricing at all. This means **LandWell would be pricing a genuinely new standalone SKU**, not benchmarking against an established comparable's stated price for the same specific thing — the €7/month and £200–500 figures above are the best available anchors, but both require a real analogy, not a direct match.

5. Risk / regulatory horizon scan — pending 2026–2027 changes across all six corridors

Consolidated from the corridor-specific tables above, with the specific 8–16-week validation window (per the mission plan) in mind. Today is 16 September 2026; a 16-week window runs to roughly early January 2027.

Corridor	Pending change	Effective date	Status as of this research	Risk to LandWell's validation window
UK	Immigration Salary List + its planned successor (Temporary Shortage List) both end entirely	31 December 2026	Confirmed by two independent trackers; stems from the May 2025 immigration white paper	High and time-boxed — falls inside a 16-week validation window starting today. Any UK country-pack content citing ISL-based reduced thresholds will go stale mid-pilot if the pilot runs into Q4 2026/Q1 2027.
UK	"Earned Settlement" reform — ILR qualifying period 5→10 years	Targeted for implementation April 2026, but the core change is not yet law , expected autumn 2026 Parliamentary consideration	Still pending, per House of Commons Library	High, uncertain timing — could pass mid-pilot and change the UK's core value proposition (time-to-PR) while a pilot is running

Corridor	Pending change	Effective date	Status as of this research	Risk to LandWell's validation window
Netherlands	30% ruling reduces to 27% for new applicants; above-indexation HSM threshold increases; stricter recognised-sponsor rules	2027	Announced, not yet in force	Moderate, just outside the near-term window — worth flagging to any NL pilot participant as "current terms, expect tightening in 2027" rather than treating 2026 NL terms as durable
Sweden	Work-permit salary threshold reform (90% of median, ~12.5% increase; IT exempted at 75%)	Already in force from 1 June 2026	Live	Low ongoing risk (already reflected in current data above), but a good internal test of whether LandWell's content-refresh process actually catches a real threshold change that happened mid-year
Germany	No specific pending 2026/2027 legislative change found in this pass beyond the routine annual threshold recalculation (next due ~January 2027)	Routine annual	N/A	Low — Germany's Blue Card threshold mechanism is index-linked and predictable; the real Germany risk is the volume-data gap (§3.1), not regulatory change
Ireland	No specific pending 2026/2027 CSEP legislative change found in this pass	—	—	Low on regulatory grounds; the real Ireland risk is the internal data-consistency gap (§2.1)
France	No specific pending 2026/2027 Talent Passport change found in this pass	—	—	Low, but under-researched — France is new to this doc and wasn't checked as thoroughly for pending reforms as the four original corridors
Denmark	No specific pending 2026/2027 Positive List structural change found in this pass, beyond the routine occupation-list updates SIRI issues periodically	—	—	Low, but under-researched, same caveat as France

Overall read: the UK carries two live, dated regulatory risks that land inside or near the realistic validation window (ISL abolition 31 Dec 2026; ILR reform possibly passing this autumn). No other corridor researched carries a comparably time-boxed risk. This reinforces, with two additional specific findings, the first pass's conclusion that the UK is the least stable corridor to build durable country-pack content around right now — but the Netherlands' 46% volume decline and pending 2027 tightening mean it should no longer be treated as a safely stable "growing" alternative either.

6. Corrections and materially new findings versus the existing docs (updated from the first pass's §4)

1. **Jobbatical's own candidate-facing-to-B2B pivot (§1.2) is the single most important new strategic-risk finding of this deeper pass** — direct historical precedent for the risk that the real paying need in this space sits downstream of "which vacancy should I apply to," in post-offer logistics, not upstream of it.
2. **Localyze was acquired by Boundless Immigration on 1 October 2025** — should no longer be cited as an independent Berlin startup; it's now part of a larger US immigration platform, a second consolidation signal alongside the Jobbatical pivot.
3. **JobPing's actual pricing (€7/month, visa filtering as a paid feature) is the closest real-world pricing anchor found for LandWell's own pilot pricing** — this closes the first pass's complete absence of pricing/WTP research.
4. **Netherlands HSM demand is confirmed sharply shrinking (46% decline, 2022→2025)** — reverses the first pass's "no data found" framing and moves the Netherlands into the same "shrinking corridor" risk category as the UK.
5. **Ireland's 2025 vs. 2024 permit-volume figures don't reconcile cleanly (31,044 vs. 39,390)** — this is a new, disclosed data-quality flag, not a confident correction in either direction; Ireland's demand direction should now be treated as unresolved rather than "growing."
6. **Two wholly new corridors researched to comparable depth:** France (Talent Passport, notably the no-quota/no-labour-market-test structural difference) and Sweden/Denmark (Nordic schemes, including a real, dated, already-in-force Swedish threshold reform from 1 June 2026 with an IT-specific exemption).
7. **The UK's Immigration Salary List has a confirmed hard end date (31 December 2026)**, resolving the first pass's open "if it still exists" question — and that end date now falls inside a realistic reading of the mission plan's validation window, which is new, actionable risk information.
8. **Germany's EU Blue Card volume-trend data gap persists even after a dedicated retry in this deeper pass** — this should now be treated as a structurally hard-to-close gap (Eurostat's own publication cadence is the bottleneck, not search effort), rather than something a future research pass is likely to resolve without a direct BAMF/destatis dataset pull.
9. **No consumer product anywhere found prices a standalone candidate-facing visa/sponsorship eligibility check** — LandWell would be defining a new SKU category's price point, not matching an existing one; the closest available anchors are JobPing's bundled €7/month feature and the £200–500 formal-lawyer-assessment range as an upper bound.

What this changes about the plan (updated)

Nothing here changes the mission plan's core sequencing — the founder-interview bottleneck remains the actual next action. But this deeper pass sharpens the inputs further than the first pass did:

- **The Jobbatical pivot and Localyze acquisition together are the strongest reason yet to treat the candidate-facing "should I apply" layer as an unproven business model, not just an unclaimed niche.** This doesn't mean don't build it — it means the founder-interview questions in `slice-selection-interview-kit.md` should specifically probe whether candidates would pay *before* applying (LandWell's bet) or

only value help *after* getting an offer (where Jobbatical/Localyze/Deel already compete and where the money has historically gone).

- **A concrete price point is now testable**, not just a research gap: something in the **€5–20 one-time-fee or €5–10/month range**, anchored against JobPing's €7/month and comfortably below any lawyer-consultation price, is the number to actually put in front of pilot users at mission-plan step 6, rather than guessing.
- **The Netherlands should be re-scored alongside the UK as a higher-mobility-risk corridor**, not treated as a safe fallback if the UK looks too volatile — both now have hard double-digit-percentage demand declines, just on different timeframes.
- **The UK's 31 December 2026 ISL sunset is a concrete date to build a content-freshness checkpoint around**, regardless of which corridor is ultimately chosen for the pilot — it's a real test of whether the country-pack maintenance process actually catches a scheduled, publicly announced change before it goes stale.
- **France, Sweden, and Denmark are now viable candidates for corridor-selection scoring on the same evidentiary footing as the original four**, though all three still lack volume/trend data and pending-reform screening as thorough as the UK/Netherlands got in this pass — a reasonable next research increment if any of them becomes a live candidate.
- **Software developer as the #1 cross-border hiring role, from Deel's own million-contract dataset (§3.3, 17 Sept follow-up), is independent, outside-the-company evidence for the tech-first sector-scope decision** — not a LandWell assumption. It doesn't validate any particular corridor, but it does validate that "tech, cross-border" is real hiring-market activity, not a narrow niche invented for this product.
- **Germany's 21-month Blue Card PR timeline is now corroborated by a second, operationally-grounded source (Deel's own case data)**, independent of the statutory citation already in §2.2 — one of the few figures in this whole document with two genuinely independent sources agreeing.

This document does not supersede any of the four docs it was asked to build on. It is net-new reference material, now on its third pass (two deep passes plus a 17 September Deel-report follow-up). Sources are linked inline throughout; where only secondary sources were available, that's flagged explicitly. Remaining flagged follow-ups: direct fetches of enterprise.gov.ie, gov.uk, [IND.nl](https://ind.nl), [BAMF/statistik.arbeitsagentur.de](https://bamf/statistik.arbeitsagentur.de), and siri.dk, before any figure here is used in user-facing product copy.